UQCS Annual General Meeting

Held on Thursday, 16th of October, 2025

Following this document is an Appendix containing, in the following order, the reports of the President, Secretary, Treasurer, Media Officer, Industry Officer, Event Officer, and the audit approval.

Meeting was **opened** at 5:19PM. Richard Yu chaired.

Quorum

28 required. 32 attendees. Quorum was met.

Confirmation of Previous Minutes

Richard Yu motioned to accept the 2024 SGM v2 minutes, Iain Jensen seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Richard Yu concludes confirmation of previous general meeting minutes.

Executive Reports

The president's report was given by Richard Yu. No further questions were asked. Richard motioned to accept the report, Jimmy Dearlove objects, and passed a message on from Bradley that officers need to post their reports 72 hours before AGM. Richard motioned to accept report, Masham Siddiqui seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Secretary's report was given by Jesse Wang. No further questions asked. Jesse motioned to accept the report, Jimmy Dearlove objects, again passing on message that officers need to post their reports 72 hours before AGM. Jesse motioned to accept the report, Iain Jensen seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Treasurer's report was given by Zain Al-Saffi.

He announced that The UQ Computing Society external audit for 2024-2025 had passed and that the society was awaiting the UQ Union audit.

Zain explained the figures which can be found in the Treasurer's report in the appendix, and explained events expenses being 0 dollars due to counting it in catering.

Jimmy Dearlove asked about the Stripe fees being 0 dollars. Zain explained membership fees from Stripe were counted under another expense. Jimmy commented it should be better to remove the Stripe fees and events expenses since it was misleading.

Zain motioned to accept the report, Masham seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Media Officer's report was given by April Kidd. April motioned to accept the report, Jimmy Dearlove seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Event Officer's report was given by Tyreece Paul. Tyreece motioned to accept the report, Masham seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Sponsors Officer's report was given by Masham Siddiqui. Masham motioned to accept the report, Richard seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

At 6:32PM Richard motioned to adjourn the meeting for 20 minutes to not starve, April Kidd seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Meeting was **adjourned** at 6:32PM. Meeting was **resumed** at 6:55PM.

Appointment of Returning Officer

Jimmy Dearlove was nominated for Returning Officer. No other nominations were received from the floor. Iain asked if Jimmy was running for any other positions; Jimmy confirmed he was not.

Jimmy Dearlove was appointed as the Returning Officer.

Creation of New Officer Positions

Jimmy proposed creating additional officer positions and asked if there were any objections. Richie noted he had no concerns. Jimmy motioned to recreate three officer positions: an Events Officer, an Industry Officer, and a Media Officer. Seconded by Zain.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Number of General Committee Members

The committee recommended having seven (7) General Committee members. Iain asked whether a total of thirteen (13) committee members was valid by meeting quorum requirements. Jesse Wang confirmed that the committee size was valid.

Jimmy motioned to create seven (7) General Committee member positions, seconded by Iain Jensen.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Announcement and Dissolution of Committee

Jimmy proposed a 30-second speech limit for all nominees. Harsha suggested increasing it to 45 seconds, and several members noted that T3 positions could allow longer speeches.

Jimmy amended the proposal to:

- 1.5 minutes for T3 positions,
- 1 minute for officer positions, and
- 30 seconds for general committee positions.

Zain suggested that uncontested roles should have shorter or no speeches. Jackie proposed limiting the number of questions to avoid dragging out discussions.

An additional amendment was proposed to allow a maximum of two (2) questions per role, with total question time roughly matching the speech duration.

Iain seconded the motion.

Motion passed by majority vote.

The Returning Officer moved to dissolve the current Management Committee, seconded by Zain.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Nominations

President. One (1) valid nomination was made prior to the AGM: Zain Al-Saffi. No nominations were received from the floor.

Nominees:

- Zain Al-Saffi

Zain gave a speech.

Elected unopposed: Zain Al-Saffi.

Secretary. One (1) valid nomination was made prior to the AGM: April Kidd. No nominations were received from the floor.

Nominees:

- April Kidd

April gave a speech.

Elected unopposed: April Kidd.

Treasurer. Three (3) valid nominations were made prior to the AGM: April Kidd, Zain Al-Saffi and John Pioc. No nominations were received from the floor.

April Kidd and Zain Al-Saffi were removed from the nominees list as they had been elected Secretary and President respectively.

Nominees:

- John Pioc

John gave a speech.

Elected unopposed: John Pioc.

Events Officer. Two (2) valid nominations were made prior to the AGM: Jevi Waugh and Clare Johnston. Jevi withdrew their nomination. No nominations were received from the floor.

Tyreece spoke about what being an events officer entails.

Nominees:

- Clare Johnston

Clare gave a speech.

Elected unopposed: Clare Johnston.

Industry Officer. Three (3) valid nominations were made prior to the AGM: April Kidd, Clare Johnston and Jevi Waugh. No nominations were received from the floor.

April Kidd and Clare Johnston were removed from the nominees list as they had been elected Secretary and Events Officer respectively.

Nominees:

- Jevi Waugh

Jevi gave a speech.

Elected unopposed: Jevi Waugh.

Media Officer. Two (2) valid nominations were made prior to the AGM: Richard Yu and Suvin Chin Chandran. No nominations were received from the floor.

April spoke about what being a media officer entails. Masham and Harsha emphasised it's about creating graphics, descriptions, making the actual post etc. Jimmy spoke about the importance of the role for keeping the society informed about what is happening. Nominees:

- Richard Yu
- Suvin Chin Chandran

The speeches were given in the preceding order.

No objections for Iain to help Jimmy count votes.

Elected: Richard Yu.

General Members of the Management Committee. Twelve (12) valid nominations were made prior to the AGM.

April Kidd and Richard Yu were removed from the nominees list as they have been elected Secretary and Media Officer respectively. Henry Bui was removed as they withdraw via email prior to the AGM.

There were two (2) nominations from the floor. The following nominations were received from the floor:

- Jason Jung nominated himself (Isaac seconded)
- Jayden Niddri nominated himself (Sean Mclennan seconded)

Before speeches, Isaac asked for people to give their Discord username and Iain asked for 1 serious question.

Nominees:

- Tyreece Paul
- Ryan Hurst
- Gideon McKinlay
- Sean McLennan
- Chris Meng
- Tristan Green
- Suvin Chin Chandran
- Sarthak Negi
- Faizan Ahmad
- Jason Jung
- Jayden Niddri

The nominees gave speeches in the order listed above. Tristan was not present. Faizan was not present so Tyreece spoke on their behalf. Sarthak was not present so the chair played a video they submitted.

No objections for Iain to help Jimmy count votes.

To give time for counting, Jimmy returns chair for Richard to continue with general business.

Richard Yu resumed the chair.

Constitutional Amendments

Jimmy asked about order; Richard confirmed that it proceeds from oldest first.

PR #64. Draft Minutes Availability. Jimmy spoke on behalf of the motion. No questions raised. No objections from the floor. Jimmy motioned for this PR to be approved, seconded.

Motion passed by supermajority vote.

Clarification sought regarding whether this had already been passed in the last General Meeting (was confirmed not).

PR #68. Change structure of exec removal. Serves to clarify how the endorsement of removal works. No one wished to speak on this PR.

Iain queries Quinn regarding the wording of line 151 in constitution.md.

Motion to approve PR - Majority in favour, none against, some abstain.

Motion passed by supermajority vote.

PR #69. Lower proxy vote limit to one per person. Max Guppy spoke on behalf of Alexander Arthur, advocating for lowering the proxy threshold to 1.

Quinn commented on the C&S model proxy voting rules.

Gideon asked about statistics on proxy numbers versus attendees.

Iain raised concerns about wording, noting that proxies should represent long-term members who cannot attend, and suggested alternative measures such as extending the proxy period.

Jimmy commented on alumni participation and their voice within the university context.

Harsha raised the issue of distinguishing members and alumni, noting student number filtering could assist. Discussion followed on whether alumni votes should carry equal weight.

Jimmy asked whether to table or vote. Motion to vote moved by Jimmy, seconded by Gideon.

Majority abstained. The motion was tabled by majority vote.

PR #70. Add Time Limits To General Meetings. Richard invited Bradley to speak on the PR. Bradley noted the AGM often runs long and the intent is to streamline meetings.

April clarified that "General Meeting" refers to both SGM and AGM.

Jimmy questioned the background and suggests tabling due to Bradley not remembering some of the details of the PR. Richard motioned to table, seconded by Harsha.

Motion tabled by majority vote.

PR #48. Changes To Election Process. Jimmy asked if Bradley wishes to withdraw the motion.

Bradley stated that while changes would be good, they should be discussed further. Jimmy recommends committee discussion at a later meeting. No further comments. Richard motioned to table, seconded by April.

Motion tabled by majority vote.

PR #51. Withdrawn.

PR #59. Create voting_puisne.py. Proposal to include the voting algorithm in the repository to assist future general meetings. No objections.

Jimmy motioned to approve PR, seconded by Quinn.

Motion passed by majority vote.

PR #60. Remove committee member. Richard asked Jackie if he wishes to withdraw. Jackie declined, citing the issue's ongoing importance.

Iain motioned to table, seconded by Jackie.

Motion tabled by majority vote.

PR #61. Pizza Clause. Several comments made in support of adding humour to the constitution. Max Guppy queries enforcement if the committee fails to meet this clause.

Iain motioned, seconded by Gideon.

Bradley notes that as a legal document, technical non-compliance (e.g. donating to charity instead of pizza) could be interpreted literally.

Jimmy motioned to vote, seconded by April.

Motion fails — nays in majority. Withdrawn.

Announcement of General Committee

Meeting returned to the announcement of General Committee election results.

Elected: Chris Meng, Gideon McKinlay, Jason Jung, Ryan Hurst, Sean McLennan, Suvin Chin Chandran, Tyreece Paul

General Business

Jimmy formally recommended that the "Pizza Rule" be adopted as a standing committee rule. The rule would require UQCS to provide a Hawaiian pizza at any event where pizza is offered. William Lowe seconded.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Richard motioned to close the meeting, seconded by Gideon McKinlay.

Motion passed by majority vote.

Meeting was **closed** at 9:02 PM. Quorum was maintained (29 remaining)

List of Proxies

- Bradley Stone to James Dearlove
- Arthur Lin to Jia-Jie Dinh Chang
- Nhat Quang Dang to Jia-Jie Dinh Chang
- Alice Lesmes to Clare Johnston
- Jayden Phan to Ryan Hurst
- Alexander Arthur to Max Guppy
- Sonja McNeilly to Richard Yu
- Kevin (Guoyang) Luo to Richard Yu
- Cielo Nicolosi to April Kidd
- Mahalia Policar to Chris Meng
- Jasper Chong to Chris Meng
- Rex Ball to Jason Jung

UQCS Presidential Year in Review

What a year it has been. I am glad we have made it to the end, and even more glad to say that we finished our last SGM with 13 committee members and are closing the year with 13 still standing strong. That level of continuity has not been achieved in a very long time.

Let me share how my UQCS journey began. Back at Market Day 2023, I stumbled across the UQCS tent by chance. I had just wrapped up my Engineering courses and was looking for new connections in the computer science community. Guarding the tent was a lone, tall man- who I later learned was Conor Geissman. To this day I still wonder where the rest of the committee was. This charismatic man introduced me to the club. I was soon rizzed, so I joined by tossing him a gold coin. That year, I only made it to a handful of events- the BBQ, CodeJam, and Hackathon- but those small steps would change everything.

The real turning point came when I ran into Sonja, the Treasurer at the time, during a gathering in the Red Room. In passing, she suggested I should run for Treasurer at the upcoming AGM. I was thrilled by the idea, but on the day itself, I had second thoughts since I had barely participated in clubs and society activities. With some encouragement (or perhaps peer pressure) from Miri and my friend Ary, I decided to run- and somehow walked out as the 2024 Treasurer. I could never have imagined that nearly three years after first meeting Conor at that tent, I would be standing here as the 2025 President, giving my final AGM speech.

As the curtain falls on the 2025 committee, these years will remain some of the most meaningful of my university life. I could not have led UQCS to where it is today without the committee beside me every step of the way. Coming in as a T3 in 2024 with zero experience, I am deeply grateful for the support of both past and present teams 2024 committee.

UQCS has now existed for 14 years, and I truly believe no other society shares the same strength of community and connection that we do. And, of course, we have one person to blame- Jason Citron, the founder of Discord.

Objectives

The presidents always set us goals, missions and objectives when we are elected. You made also consider us as object oriented programmed.

1. **Fostering a strong committee bond**
   To work effectively as a team, I believe every committee member needs to feel comfortable with each other. That is why I put effort into building friendships within the committee, not just working relationships. A big part of this was our committee chill chat channel, where we shared funny, casual conversations outside of work. This gave everyone a chance to relax, get to know each other better, and ultimately feel more proactive when stepping into their roles. Thanks to this approach, many of our newer members adapted quickly and grew confident in contributing to event planning and society initiatives.

2. **Increase the number of student talks**
   Based on community feedback, UQCS aimed to host more student-led talks in 2025. When planning the semester calendar, we deliberately left several flexible weeks open for students to step in. This year, we thank Max, Matt Young, Schom Gadd, and Paul Vrbik for sharing their knowledge and inspiring our members with engaging and insightful talks.

3. **Strengthening engagement with other societies**
   Collaborating with other student societies has been a major focus this year. These events gave our members opportunities to meet people from different disciplines, share ideas, and

experience activities outside of a purely computer science setting. It also brought fresh inspiration to our own events, adding variety and keeping our weekly line-up engaging. Since becoming President, UQCS has co-hosted six events with other societies, spanning social, industry, and technical themes. Highlights include:

- Two social drinking events with multiple societies
- SIG Brain Teaser with UQFintech
- Trivia Night with UQFintech and UQRL
- High Frequency Networking with UQLIT and EBESS
- AllUni Hackathon with several societies

These collaborations not only created new event ideas but also (perhaps unsurprisingly) led to the creation of many Messenger group chats along the way, which I got lost in. Looking forward, I strongly encourage the next committee to continue strengthening UQCS's relationships with other societies. Doing so will broaden our members' social lives, spark fresh opportunities, and keep the UQCS name well recognised across campus.

Closing Remarks and Thank Yous

As I said at the beginning, none of my goals this year could have been achieved without the other 12 committee members who stood by me. UQCS continues to grow because of the people behind it, and I hope future committees are made up of people as brilliant, glamorous, and dedicated as all of you. Whether you joined for the resume boost, radiant/aura, or a genuine passion for the society, I am truly glad to have met and worked with each of you.

Now, I want to thank you all individually.

To Harsha, David, Cielo, and Yuraj- your help during the hackathon and our weekly events was irreplaceable. The event would not have run the same without your efforts.

To Chris- you've been the mailman of UQCS, taking on the legwork no one else wanted to, like collecting endless deliveries from the Union building. Those tasks may not have been glamorous, but they were essential, and I'm grateful you stepped up to get them done. Beyond that, you've also been the sunshine of the committee- bringing light, humour, and energy that made our working environment vibrant and enjoyable.

If you've enjoyed our Instagram designs this year, you need to thank April and Anshul. Anshul created every single post for Semester 1 events before they even started, and April designed most of our media for the year, as well as assisting with event planning and preparation behind the scenes. You both kept UQCS looking sharp. And April you consistently joined meeting despite keeping a busy schedule. I really appreciate it.

Failure is stepping stone to success. Tyreece, now I can confidently say that you have accumulated enough stepping stones that success is finally within your grasp. Your activeness during this semester is outstanding. Because of this your accumulation of stepping stones through means of failure is roughly 1 per week. Just like me when I joined UQCS last year, I was consistently roasted and flamed by my bosses so don't be disheartened. I wish you would have learnt great things this semester and best of luck with your future endeavours.

To Jesse- my reliable Secretary. You are the only person that stayed on committee since 2024. Your work this year and last year is rock solid, taking flawless minutes during meetings and you were there at most events to provide extra manpower and carry out tasks with precision every time especially during hackathon. I could always count on you.

Zain- you brought joy and humour to the committee with your eccentric energy. Every time I opened the committee chill chat, I learnt a new word, phrase, or metaphor that they did not teach me at ESL nor English classes. Those words, phrases and metaphors help me to be more expressive during stressful situations. Beyond that, you also safeguarded the society's finances, proving that humour and responsibility really can go hand in hand. So shukran lak ya sadiqi, which I believe means thank you my friend in Arabian.

I also want to acknowledge Jackie Chang, an ex-committee member. Even though things didn't end as expected the work you did last year remain invaluable. You tirelessly handled logistics and emails, and you taught me the ins and outs of UQCS. I still remember those late nights staying up until 2am drafting emails and event documents- they were fun times. Please learn from your mistakes, chin up and keep walking forward because forward is where the finish line lies.

And finally, Masham. I wish I'd met you sooner or that you'd joined UQCS earlier. You've taught me many society skills and guided me with advice when I needed it most. You have assisted me with UQCS during its hardest moments. During my presidency you assisted me with every event logistics, catering and pointed out potential logical errors that I have made. I'm grateful for every step you've walked alongside me. Outside of UQCS, you also taught me valuable lessons in catering- like what halal and haram mean, the difference between vegan and vegetarian, and that "GF" stands for gluten free, not girlfriend. You are a studious and sharp person, and I wish you great success in the future.

Finally, to the whole society- thank you for trusting me as your President this year, and, importantly, for not throwing a second coup d'état.

To conclude the report, I'll leave you with this quote which roughly translates to "When drinking water, remember the one that dug the well". It means to gratitude for those who made you current benefits possible. May the next UQCS committee bring peace, stability, and economic prosperity to our society. With that, my watch has ended. Bello, Bella Ciao.

Lots of love,

Richard Yu
2025 UQCS President

UQCS Secretary Year in Review

I'd like to start by giving a big thank you to the UQCS community and the amazing 2025 committee members, both past and present. Many strange things happened (least of which was doing a handover with Tyreece past midnight), but we pulled through and delivered some fantastic events. I'm genuinely grateful for the opportunity to have served as Secretary for part of this year.

Event Collaborations

As per our yearly tradition, we once again collaborated with UQLIT and EBESS for HFN. This partnership is really positive and is definitely worth maintaining going forward. We also once again collaborated with UQLIT for the Mock Interviews Night event this year. It could be worth reaching out to see if they'd like to collaborate on their resume review event as well.

This year also saw more collaborations with UQRL and UQFinTech, thanks to several committee members being involved with those clubs or having close connections. These events turned out great and would be wonderful to continue, even with the incoming committee.

Our indsutry collaboration events this year were primarily with Fintech-focused companies. Tak ing inspiration from UQLIT, reaching out to more local sponsors for opportunities like office tours or mentoring sessions could help diversify our industry collaborations.

In previous years, we've stopped running joint events with clubs like MSS and UQ Cyber Squad. Reconnecting with them would be a great way to strengthen inter-club ties moving forward.

Direction of Club

An important point I want to highlight in this report is the direction the club is heading. As our community continues to grow, there's been an increasing demand for industry and networking focused events.

This year, we dedicated more time to organising industry-related events, which I believe is a great direction for the club to take. However, we shouldn't forget that UQCS has always been about a love for programming, not just about getting a j*b. Having a few industry-focused events each semester worked really well, and I'd encourage future committees to maintain that balance.

While industry events generally attracted higher attendance than student talks, we should never overlook the importance of these. The future committee might consider experimenting with new formats to increase engagement. One idea we wanted to try but didn't get the chance to was running back-to-back talks (sort of like a "night of talks"), to make talk-style events more engaging and appealing to a broader range of members.

Lastly, I'd like to thank this year's committee once again and wish next year's committee the best of luck.

Jesse Wang
UQCS Secretary

Treasurer's Report

Finances Overview: UQCS successfully passed the external audit for the 2024–2025 financial year. The primary goal this term was to minimise overspending and avoid entering a deficit. We achieved this — recording a modest loss of only $214.82, which is notably lower than previous years and close to our target of breaking even.

The year opened with a balance of $27,895.29 and closed with $27,680.47, comprising $33,992.79 in income and $34,207.61 in expenses. Purchases included catering and supplies for joint events (BBQs, Mock Interviews, Hackathon) and regular groceries such as cup noodles and Milo.

Income Summary:

- Sponsorship: $19,999.27
- Events Income: $10,409.10
- Grants: $3,304.00
- Memberships: $750.06
- Joint Events: $244.91
- Merchandise Income:-$714.55

Expenses Summary:

- Catering: $19,571.43
- Prizes: $5,250.00
- Pizza: $3,912.32
- Merchandise Expenses: $3,267.74
- Printing & Stationery: $786.98
- Other (audit, marketing, etc.): $419.00

Key Highlights:

- Achieved near break-even with a deficit of only $214.82.
- Increased sponsorship revenue significantly, thanks to efforts by the Industry Officer.
- Improved financial tracking and categorisation for events and catering.

Challenges and Areas for Improvement:

- Hackathon Spending: Historically a major contributor to deficits. The increase in ticket prices was a necessary correction informed by sponsorship levels and CPI adjustments.
- Budget Planning: Greater structure in setting an emergency fund could improve flexibility during large events.

Treasurer's Advice: Establish a fixed Excel-based budget that includes a buffer for overspend ing during large-scale events such as Hackathon. Future committees should use the existing pric ing model as a baseline heuristic when determining event ticket pricing, and collaborate closely with the Industry Officer to explore increasing sponsorship package rates.

Treasurer's Remarks: Although the year began with challenges, it concluded successfully. I am grateful to have served as Treasurer and proud of what our committee achieved. Special thanks go to:

- Masham — for her exceptional effort in securing record sponsorships and maintaining committee stability.
- Richard — for his leadership and mentorship in creating an inclusive and supportive environment.
- Jesse — for his consistency and organisation as Secretary, ensuring smooth operations.
- April — for her creativity and dedication in producing excellent media work.
- Tyreece — for bringing energy and humour to the committee (despite the room booking chaos).
- The General Committee — for their reliability and commitment, especially Yuvraj for his dedication in difficult circumstances.

Finally, thank you to the UQCS cohort — without you, there would be no UQ Computing Society.

Sincerely,

Zain Al-Saffi
UQCS Treasurer

Media Officer's Review

Facebook: Engagement mainly coming from Instagram reposts and stories, but remains relatively consistent.

Instagram: Followers increased from 2,771 as of the last AGM to 4,669 as of the 12th of October. Started posting reels with good engagement.

Discord: Had an increase of roughly 400 members from last year, with a 40% new member retention.

Linktree: 3.38k views and 73.8% click rate since introduction, great addition from last year's committee.

LinkedIn: Still haven't posted here. It could be good to do next year for industry events or student talk recaps.

Key Milestones:

- Over 4,500 followers on Instagram
- Discord member count is closing in on 2.5k
- Over 150 posts on Instagram

Issues and Areas for Improvement:

- Throughout the 2025 committee, we had 3 changes in who was Media Officer, with myself being the most recent as of late August. This, naturally, caused issues throughout the year with performance and continuity.
- A more structured media development lifecycle could improve outcomes and speed up turnaround. Something to explore in future.

Overall, an incredible year, and an absolutely delightful team to work with. Thank you all!

April Kidd
UQCS Media Officer

Industry Officer – Masham Siddiqui

Firstly, I was trying to see on GitHub what I could base my report on, but there really wasn't much for Industry Officer reports. So here I am, writing my own structure from scratch. I believe this year I reshaped what the Industry Officer role looks like and how our sponsorship structure works. So really, it makes sense that I am building from scratch what could be the basis of Industry Officer reports in the future.

Overview

This year was about sharpening the role after a proper look at how it ran in past years. I introduced an **Emerald tier**, lifted the base package price, and rebuilt the prospectus to be clearer and more accurate, with a full page on CPG so sponsors can see the competitive programming stream. I kept a live, always-updated document with our calendar and open slots so partners could plan without back and forth. Above all, I was deliberate in how I ran sponsorship conversations and events so the value was obvious on both sides.

Sponsorship Snapshot

Tier	Company	Amount
Emerald	Boeing	$3,081.66
Emerald	Technology One	$3,000.00
Emerald	Oracle	$3,000.00
Emerald	Jane Street	$3,000.00
Gold	Swyftx	$2,500.00
Gold	JR Academy	$2,500.00
Silver	SIG	$2,000.00
Silver	Optiver (Bespoke)	$1,500.00
Bronze	VivCourt	$1,000.00
Bronze	IMC	$1,000.00
	Total	**$22,581.66**

Additional in-kind support came from the Australian Computer Society, Red Bull, and Ciao Bello.

How it Compares

Year	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019
Total ($)	22,581.66	15,500.00	22,467.25	30,721.74	33,217.32	12,276.15	18,690.95

That's a 45.7% increase from 2024. It's roughly level with 2023, but still below the 2021 to 2022 peak when tech companies were sponsoring more often. The job market is slowly recovering, but that is not what drove this. Most sponsors returned. The lift came from initiative, clearer documents, and early planning. Changing how the packages looked, and the pricing, helped too. I sent my first sponsorship email in October 2024, which is early for most companies that are only just starting to plan next year's budgets for early careers and campus work.

What Changed and Why

Emerald tier: Basically the old Gold tier reimagined. Emerald took the previous Gold price, and Gold moved down in price. I shifted the focus toward access and exposure. The Bronze and Silver tiers also increased in price.

Prospectus refresh: Removed filler, added real examples, and gave CPG a full page to em phasise the UQCS competitive programming side.

Live sponsor doc: A rolling calendar with event slots, FAQs, and status notes. Sponsors could check it anytime without waiting for replies.

Follow-ups: I made sure sponsors actually used their benefits. It might sound simple, but I noticed that when inclusions went unused, sponsors often did not return or dropped a tier. A few even mentioned it was because they had not used everything last time, whether by choice or just forgetting. So this year I sent kind reminders about remaining benefits to show that we notice and value their support. It is a small thing that builds trust, helps maintain the relationship, supports UQCS in the long run, and keeps my outward presence professional.

Outreach and Relationships

I started outreach about a month after AGM and honestly just grinded through it. Short, direct emails, most even before I had the prospectus finalised, just to gauge early interest. It's a good place to start, especially since exams run through mid to late November. I also had a fair few calls with sponsors, which really helped. I found that sponsors I spoke to over calls generally felt more trust, especially if they were unsure which package to choose.

A few highlights:

- **IMC Trading** sponsored CodeJam again.
- **Technology1** moved from one-off event support to a full sponsorship tier (Emerald, the highest one).
- **Red Bull** sponsored both CodeJam and Hackathon.
- **Amazon** and **Canva** joined us at key events like Mock Interviews, Industry Panel, and High Frequency Networking. Amazon also helped judge Hackathon.
- The **First Year Guide** was upgraded this year (reintroduced after a few years). Emerald sponsors had full-page ads, while the other tiers still got space but smaller mentions. The guide should continue evolving each year to represent the current sponsors and incoming committee.

Events that Stood Out

Industry Panel at The Precinct. I brought the Industry Panel back this year but ran it off-campus at The Precinct in Fortitude Valley. The **Australian Computer Society** sponsored the venue and, as of this year, is a full-year sponsor (just not monetarily). Their partnership with us offers the venue once a year as one of their benefits and provides memberships to all UQCS members, which was great. Industry Panel sold 104 tickets and featured speakers from **Amazon**, **Oracle**, **VivCourt**, **Boeing**, and **Swyftx**. Technology1 also attended as an industry representative, alongside a few others from the panel companies. I MC'd and ran the Q&A too!

HFT collabs: Jane Street and Susquehanna were both incredible to work with. The Brain teaser Battle with UQ FinTech, the Jane Street Estimathon, and their pop-up were all great events. I will say, we now have an excess of merch from that pop-up that the storeroom might take years to recover from.

Comms and Consistency

All job listings and sponsor announcements went through our main socials (Instagram, Facebook, and Discord) to keep everything centralised. It worked well and made sponsor visibility much easier to track. If I had more time (and something I'd recommend to next year's committee), I would've mirrored those posts on the website. A few people mentioned to me that they mainly check the website for updates, and while it already shows upcoming events, it would be nice to have job opportunities listed there too.

Social sponsors were a smaller focus but still worth pursuing. We brought on Red Bull as a proper sponsor this year and added Ciao Bello's 10% discount (huge thanks to Zain for that). The next step would be introducing digital membership cards so social sponsors can easily verify UQCS members, since membership verification is often a requirement for them. I'd avoid physical cards, as they would be difficult to manage long term and would make it harder for members who join throughout the year to access their benefits right away.

I also co-ran the "Getting the Grad or Internship" and "Cracking the Behavioural" sessions with Zain. It was nice to share insight and just have genuine conversations about what actually works (and what doesn't).

For Whoever Comes Next

- Build a simple sponsor hub on the website. Even a basic one helps.
- Push for digital membership cards to make social sponsors actually workable.
- Keep the Emerald tier exclusive and high-value. Check in mid-year (for semester-long packages) and adjust benefits if needed. Communicate with the Treasurer to see if the overall packages need to be priced differently after reflecting on logistics and financials from the past year.

Thank You

This role is a lot of work, but it's also a privilege. Massive thanks to **Richard** for the late-night logistics chats and helping me through the crashouts, **Jesse** for always showing up, keeping brilliant minutes, and doing the pizza runs with me, and **Zain** for co-hosting events and help ing with sponsors. To the rest of the committee: thank you for the laughs between tasks, the late-night debriefs that somehow made the workload feel lighter, and for building a space that wasn't just about finishing jobs off. It felt like the perfect balance between friends and teammates.

As my time at uni wraps up very soon, it is a bit bittersweet. I have been in clubs for so long that stepping away feels strange, but I am glad I chose to be in UQCS for my final year. Thanks for making it the right place to finish the run.

Signing out for 2025

Masham Siddiqui
UQCS Industry Officer

Events Officer Review

Events Overview: UQCS flagship events (Codejam, Hackathon, HFN, Mock Interviews) reached impressive turnout rates and were overall highly successful. Industry Panel was reintroduced which also saw high attendance.

Key Highlights:

- Industry Panel: Strong attendance (104 participants), served as solid opening event.
- Codejam: Lower turnouts than previous year (69 participants), following decline in attendance from previous years.
- Mock Interviews: Lower turnout than previous year (52 attendees) but close to max capacity.
- Hackathon: Sold out event (180 attendees), consistent with previous years.
- HFN: Another sold out event (124 participants), improved venue allowed for larger attendee capacity.

Strong social events with standouts being Semester 1 EOS (99 Attendees), Semester 2 Launch Party (55 Attendees) and Trivia (68 Attendees). Built very good tradition of having 1st year friendly events (student talks, 1st year panel), with strong turnout. Collaboration events with UQLit continued to be really good, with other significant collaboration partners including UQRL, UQIES and UQFintech. Solid sponsor event lineup.

Challenges and Areas for Improvement

- Disruption: Midyear changes within the leadership team led to some challenges in continuity and planning. While momentum was maintained, the transition period created short-term disruption.
- Event Scheduling: Toward the latter half of the year, multiple events were concentrated within a short timeframe. Going forward, we could improve by spacing out activities more evenly and ensuring a broader variety of events are distributed throughout the year to maximise engagement.

Overall, this period proved successful and our committee worked together to overcome challenges faced.

Tyreece Paul
UQCS Events Officer



Hey The University of Queensland Computing Society

Congratulations, your audit has been received and your club has been marked as compliant.

Figure 1: UQU Annual Financial Return Approval



Audit Right

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SPAA SMSF SPECIALIST

Auditor's Verification Statement for the year ended 31 August 2025

To the members of University of Queensland Computing Society

I have sighted the entity´s financial records for the year ended 31 August 2025, and the financial records show that the entity has book keeping processes in place to adequately record the entity´s income and expenditure and dealings with its assets and liabilities.

Basis of Accounting and Restriction on Distribution

Without modifying our opinion, we draw attention to Note 1 to the financial statements, which describes the basis of accounting. The financial report has been prepared to assist University of Queensland Computing Society to meet its reporting requirements to University of Queensland Union. As a result, the financial report may not be suitable for another purpose.

Glen Klein FCPA
Director
Audit Right Pty Ltd
26 September 2025

Figure 2: External Auditor Approval